

Endalkachew H. Chala

COMMUNITY FELLOW, CENTER FOR AN INFORMED PUBLIC

University of Washington

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Education

University of Oregon

PH.D., MEDIA STUDIES

Eugene, OR

July 2018

Addis Ababa University

M.A., JOURNALISM

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

August 2008

Dilla University

B.Ed., ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

Dilla, Ethiopia

June 2005

Academic & Research Appointments

University of Washington

COMMUNITY FELLOW, CENTER FOR AN INFORMED PUBLIC

Remote

August 2026 – present

Discourse Lab

RESEARCHER, NSF-FUNDED PROJECT

Remote

September 2023 – October 2024

- Research on public health, online discourse, and digital communication as part of an NSF-supported collaborative research project.

Hamline University

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR, COMMUNICATION STUDIES

Saint Paul, MN

September 2018 – October 2023

University of Oregon, School of Journalism and Communication

GRADUATE TEACHING ASSISTANT

Eugene, OR

August 2013 – June 2018

Addis Ababa University, Institute of Peace and Security Studies

ASSISTANT LECTURER

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

August 2012 – May 2013

Arba Minch University, Department of English

ASSISTANT LECTURER

Arba Minch, Ethiopia

September 2005 – July 2012

Publications

Author's name in **bold**. Peer-reviewed publications listed in reverse chronological order.

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

Chala, E. H. (2026). Platform oversight in practice: How language shapes procedure, not outcome, in Meta's Oversight Board. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(3). <https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i3.333>

Chala, E. H. (2026). From detection to counterspeech: Auditing AI moderation and fact-checking practices in Ethiopia's multilingual online sphere. *Media and Communication*, 14. <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.12653>

Chala, E. H., Ayalew, S., & Lyons, T. (2026). Crowdsourcing rebellion: Digital fundraising for Ethiopian rebel groups. *Civil Wars*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13698249.2026.2719413>

Workneh, T. W., Lin, M.-C., & **Chala, E. H.** (2026). Faith, displacement, and intergenerational relationships: A communication accommodation theory approach to the Ethiopian Orthodox diaspora. *Language and Intercultural Communication*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14708477.2026.2690268>

Chala, E. H. (2026). From multidimensional safety to risk ecologies: A four-coordinate analysis of journalist exposure in Ethiopia, 1992–2024. *Journalism Practice*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17512786.2026.2637127>

Chala, E. H., & Workneh, T. W. (2026). Internet shutdowns in Ethiopia: Discourses of digital sovereignty and information suppression amid political instability. *New Media & Society*, 28(9), 4942–4962. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14614448251378981>

Lemke, J., & **Chala, E. H.** (2016). An ethnographic content analysis of social media use in the differing politics of Senegal and Ethiopia's newspapers. *Journal of African Media Studies*, 8(2), 167–185. https://doi.org/10.1386/jams.8.2.167_1

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Chala, E. H. Immigrant airwaves: A critical history of Ethiopian community radios in American media evolution. *American Journalism: A Journal of Media History*. (Manuscript under review).

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Chala, E. H. From international student to dissident-in-absentia: Refuge and scholarly formation in U.S. academia. *Communication and Critical/Cultural Studies*. (Invited essay for special forum; manuscript in preparation).

Chala, E. H. Two newsrooms, two publics: How nonprofit journalism redefines locality in Minnesota. *Digital Journalism*. (Manuscript in preparation).

Selected Conference Presentations

Chala, E. H. (2026, October). *Platform oversight in practice: How language shapes procedure, not outcome, in Meta's Oversight Board* [Paper presentation, forthcoming]. Trust and Safety Research Conference, Stanford Tech Impact and Policy Center, Stanford University, Stanford, CA.

Chala, E. H. (2026, August). *Platform oversight in practice: A statistical analysis of linguistic and regional representation in the Meta Oversight Board* [Conference paper]. Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), New Orleans, LA.

Chala, E. H. (2026, August). *Contested frames: A quantitative content analysis of Twin Cities nonprofit multi-platform communication during immigration enforcement* [Poster presentation]. Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), Public Relations Division, New Orleans, LA.

Workneh, T. W., & **Chala, E. H.** (2026, August). *Competing narratives and asymmetrical framing in the coverage of the Tigray conflict* [Poster presentation]. Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), New Orleans, LA.

Workneh, T. W., & **Chala, E. H.** (2026, June). *Internet shutdowns and the politics of digital sovereignty in Ethiopia* [Conference paper]. International Communication Association (ICA), Cape Town, South Africa.

Chala, E. H. (2025, June). *Cross-border narratives: How overseas online discourse is reshaping domestic journalism practice* [Conference paper]. International Communication Association (ICA), Denver, CO.

Chala, E. H. (2025, March). *Cyber strategies and diaspora dynamics: Exploring digital financing in ethnic insurgencies in Ethiopia* [Conference paper]. International Studies Association (ISA), Chicago, IL.

Chala, E. H. (2020, May). *"Ethiopia (up)rising": The politics of sustainable development and civic desiring in Ethiopia* [Conference paper]. International Communication Association (ICA), Gold Coast, Australia (virtual).

Chala, E. H. (2018, July). *Ferments in aid-based communication empowerment campaigns: Reflection on Ethiopia's girl band, Yegna* [Conference paper]. International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR), Eugene, OR.

Chala, E. H. (2018, May). *Journalistic security & networked press freedom: Historical, regional & organizational perspectives* [Conference paper]. International Communication Association (ICA), Prague, Czech Republic.

Selected Invited Talks

Chala, E. H. (2024, May). *Local News Impact Consortium* [Invited participant]. University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, MN.

- Chala, E. H.** (2024, April). *The cultural turn in content moderation: Reimagining platform governance* [Invited talk]. Yale Law School, Information Society Project, Propaganda and Emerging Technologies Conference, New Haven, CT. [video]
- Chala, E. H.** (2023, June). *Governance in an Online Speech* [Invited panelist]. Leadership Series, Yale Law School, Information Society Project, New Haven, CT.
- Chala, E. H.** (2020, December). *Combating misinformation in under-resourced languages: Lessons from around the world* [Invited panelist]. Virtual presentation. [video]
- Chala, E. H.** (2020, January). *Disinformation, democratic processes, and conflict prevention* [Workshop facilitator]. Academic Network on Peace, Security, and the United Nations, New York, NY.
- Chala, E. H.** (2017, December). *Threatened Voices: A database for documenting threats to online speech* [Invited panelist]. Global Voices Summit, Colombo, Sri Lanka.
- Chala, E. H.** (2016, March). *Cryptography and the fight for free speech* [Invited panelist]. SXSW, Austin, TX.
- Chala, E. H.** (2015, June). *Securing the newsroom* [Invited panelist]. Committee to Protect Journalists (CPJ) Tech Summit, San Francisco, CA.
- Chala, E. H.** (2015, April). *Journalism and foreign aid* [Invited panelist]. Columbia Journalism School, Columbia University, New York, NY.
- Chala, E. H.** (2015, February). *Media, democracy and technology: Possibilities and challenges* [Invited talk]. University of Oregon, Eugene, OR.
- Chala, E. H.** (2015, January). *Charlie Hebdo: Between free speech, bigotry and blasphemy* [Invited panelist]. University of Oregon, Eugene, OR.
- Chala, E. H.** (2013, January). *Coercive internet regulation* [Invited panelist]. Stockholm Internet Forum, Stockholm, Sweden.
- Chala, E. H.** (2012, October). *Program on Liberation Technology* [Invited participant]. John S. Knight Journalism Fellowships, Stanford University, Stanford, CA.

Fellowships, Grants & Selected Professional Communities

FELLOWSHIPS & INVITED COMMUNITIES

University of Washington

COMMUNITY FELLOW, CENTER FOR AN INFORMED PUBLIC

\$5,000

August 2026 – June 2027

Cornell Brooks School of Public Policy, Cornell University

INVITED MEMBER, CENTER ON GLOBAL DEMOCRACY COMMUNITY OF PRACTICE

January 2026 – December 2026

- Invitation-only global community of scholars and practitioners focused on democracy research, policy, collaboration, and knowledge exchange.

Electronic Frontier Foundation (EFF)

GOOGLE POLICY FELLOW

\$7,500

June – August 2014

University of Oxford

ANNENBERG–OXFORD MEDIA POLICY SUMMER INSTITUTE

June – July 2012

GRANTS & FUNDING

Hamline University

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT FUND

\$1,500

September 2020 – August 2021

University of Oregon

PH.D. DISSERTATION GRANT

\$1,500

August 2017 – June 2018

University of Oregon
COLUMBIA SCHOLARSHIP

\$1,000
September 2016 – June 2017

University of Oregon
COLUMBIA SCHOLARSHIP

\$1,000
September 2015 – June 2016

University of Oregon
COLUMBIA SCHOLARSHIP

\$3,000
September 2013 – June 2014

Teaching

HAMLIN UNIVERSITY

- **JCOM 3010:** Community Listening & Civic Storytelling
- **JCOM 3028:** Story Production for Digital Media
- **JCOM 3021:** Message Design & Audience Understanding
- **JCOM 3022:** Ethical & Civic Communication: Advocacy and Public Interest
- **COMM 1100:** Introduction to Communication
- **COMM 1110:** Public Speaking
- **COMM 1750:** Small Group Communication
- **COMM 1320:** Introduction to Critical Media Studies
- **COMM 3320:** Media in the Digital Age
- **COMM 3460:** Intercultural Communication
- **COMM 3300:** Communication Research Methods
- **COMM 3420:** Media in Global Perspective
- **COMM 3421:** Introduction to Health Communication

UNIVERSITY OF OREGON

- **J100:** Media Professions
- **J201:** Media and Society
- **J207:** Gateway to Media (Strategic Communication)
- **J340:** Principles of Advertising
- **J396:** International Communication
- **J385:** Communications Law
- **J347:** Social Media Journalism
- **J408:** Advertising and Culture

ARBA MINCH UNIVERSITY

- **FLEn 201:** Sophomore English
- **FLEn 221:** Introduction to Linguistics
- **FLEn 211:** Composition & Grammar
- **FLEn 220:** Research Methods
- **FLEn 205:** Argumentation and Debate
- **FLEn 301:** Principles of Journalism
- **FLEn 311:** Media Law & Ethics
- **FLEn 305:** Technical Report Writing
- **FLEn 401:** Business Writing
- **FLEn 404:** Public Speaking
- **FLEn 405:** Senior Capstone Project
- **FLEn 421:** Sociolinguistics
- **FLEn 435:** Survey of Ethiopian Literature

Research Outputs & Resources

RESEARCH REVIEWS & POLICY REPORTS

Tower, K., & Miller, K. M. (2025). *Toolkit for trust: Strategies for better online communication*. MediaWell, Social Science Research Council. [Contributing editor to prior ARTT research review]. [link]

Chala, E. H. (2018). *Freedom on the Net 2018 — Ethiopia*. Freedom House. [link]

Chala, E. H. (2015). Defending against overreaching surveillance in Ethiopia: Surveillance self-defense. *Electronic Frontier Foundation*. [link]

DATASETS & RESEARCH RESOURCES

Chala, E. H. (2025). *Journalist Safety in Ethiopia, 1992–2024* [Dataset]. Harvard Dataverse. <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/FEPB80>

Chala, E. H. (2026). *When Translation Is Not Access: AI Translation Infrastructure and Communicative Inequality in Under-Resourced Languages* [Research dataset and reproducibility repository, in development]. Hugging Face. [repository]

CURRENT RESEARCH PROJECTS

Center for an Informed Public, University of Washington

NARRATIVE FLOWS, POLICY RESPONSE, AND COMMUNITY INFORMATION INTEGRITY IN

2026–2027

MINNESOTA

- Cross-platform research on narrative circulation, institutional response, multilingual community information flows, and community-facing information-integrity education.

Independent Research Project

WHEN TRANSLATION IS NOT ACCESS

2026–present

- Comparative study of AI translation infrastructure in Amharic and Afaan Oromo, examining semantic accuracy, pragmatic meaning, institutional communication, and actionability.

Research Project

AMERICAN MULTILINGUAL PUBLICS AND THE DIGITAL STATE

2026–present

- Research on language access, public benefits, multilingual publics, and AI-mediated communication in U.S. public institutions.

METHODS & RESEARCH INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Methods:** Statistical analysis; computational text analysis; classifier audits; web scraping; digital trace data; interviews; ethnography; archival research; discourse analysis; mixed-method research design.
- **Research infrastructure:** GitHub: github.com/Endalk-Chala | Hugging Face: huggingface.co/endalkchala | OSF: osf.io/dy4rs

Service

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Hamline University

CHAIR, INSTITUTIONAL REVIEW BOARD (IRB) COMMITTEE

September 2021 – May 2022

Hamline University

MEMBER, IRB COMMITTEE

September 2019 – December 2021

Hamline University

MEMBER, UNIVERSITY SUSTAINABILITY COMMITTEE

January 2019 – December 2021

University of Oregon

GRADUATE STUDENT REPRESENTATIVE, STRATEGIC PLANNING WORK GROUP

January – May 2015

University of Oregon

MEMBER, FACULTY POSITION SEARCH COMMITTEE

September – December 2016

DEPARTMENT SERVICE**Hamline University**

MEMBER, AD HOC COMMITTEE TO LAUNCH A DIGITAL MEDIA PRODUCTION CERTIFICATE

January 2019 – December 2021

Hamline University

JUDGE, STUDENT RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

January – May 2021

Hamline University

FIRST-YEAR STUDENT MENTOR & MAJOR EXPLORATION ADVISOR

January 2019 – December 2021

Arba Minch University

CHAIR, DEPT. OF ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE

September 2005 – December 2006

Arba Minch University

MEMBER, FACULTY POSITION SEARCH COMMITTEE

September – December 2008

Arba Minch University

COORDINATOR OF E-LEARNING SERVICE

September – December 2011

Professional Memberships

INTERNATIONAL COMMUNICATION ASSOCIATION (ICA)

September 2018 – present

ASSOCIATION FOR EDUCATION IN JOURNALISM AND MASS COMMUNICATION (AEJMC)

September 2020 – present

INTERNATIONAL ASSOCIATION FOR MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION RESEARCH (IAMCR)

September 2016 – present

AFRICAN STUDIES ASSOCIATION (ASA)

September 2020 – present

Selected Coverage in Popular Press

Adler, S. (2021, February 12). Facebook's Supreme Court. *Radiolab*. [link]Mersie, A. (2020, September 22). The Ethiopian-Egyptian water war has begun. *Foreign Policy*. [link]Abdurahman, K. (2020, November 12). Mis/Disinformation in the context of the Oromo protests (feat. Endalkachew Chala). *Castbox*.Gardner, T. (2019, March 16). Press freedom in Ethiopia has blossomed. Will it last? *The Economist*. [link]Mumo, M. (2019, April 19). Under Abiy, Ethiopia's media have more freedom, but challenges remain. *Committee to Protect Journalists (CPJ)*. [link]